

Matt Viana

Ph.D. Student in Informatics and Intelligent Systems

Curriculum Vitae

June 2026

📍 Westgate Building, University Park, PA 16802 Room E311
🏠 themattviana.github.io
✉ mmv5513@psu.edu
🔄 [themattviana](#)
🌐 [matt-viana](#)
🆔 0009-0006-7911-3885

Education

Aug 2025 - Present	Ph.D. in Informatics and Intelligent Systems (Advisor: Dr. Dana Calacci) University Park, PA	Pennsylvania State University
Aug 2022 - May 2025	B.S. in Data Science, Minor in Computer Science University Park, PA	Pennsylvania State University

Research Experience

Aug 2025 - Present	Working Futures Network, Penn State Graduate Research Assistant	Supervisor: Dr. Dana Calacci
	➤ Investigate user behavior and adoption patterns of Large Language Models (LLMs) in real-world settings. ➤ Conduct qualitative research and system audits to identify security vulnerabilities and privacy concerns in AI systems. ➤ Develop novel user feedback mechanisms to mitigate AI mirroring behaviors such as sycophancy and perspective mimesis. ➤ Collaborate on research projects exploring the interpretability of 'black box' AI models.	
Feb 2024 - Jan 2025	Pennsylvania State University AI Research Assistant	Adviser: Dr. Sharon Huang
	➤ Fine-tuned large language models (LLMs) using TensorFlow and PyCharm, incorporating an improved dataset and model published on Hugging Face. ➤ Conducted a literature review on multimodal emotional classification and interaction in large language models (LLMs). ➤ Researched NLP and Computer Vision techniques, focusing on the development of models to analyze a wide emotional spectrum. ➤ Ran experiments integrating audio, visual, and textual inputs into language models, utilizing clustering techniques and data augmentation.	

Publications

2026	Interaction Context Often Increases Sycophancy in LLMs → S Jain, C Park, M M Viana, A Wilson, D Calacci <i>[CHI] ACM CHI 2026 (Accepted, Honorable Mention Award for Outstanding Contribution)</i>
Draft	Active Negotiation: How Users Interact With and Adopt Large Language Models M Viana, P Erickson, D Calacci <i>Draft available upon request</i>

Awards & Funding

2026	Honorable Mention Award Recipient <i>ACM CHI Conference</i>
------	--

2025-2026	Rednor Graduate Fellowship Fellow <i>College of Information Sciences and Technology</i>
2025	ICDS Rising Researcher Grant Recipient <i>Institute for Computational and Data Sciences, Pennsylvania State University</i>

Invited Talks

Feb 2026	Guest Research Talk University Park, PA	Plain Text Lab (Dr. Jonathan Dodge), Pennsylvania State University
----------	---	--

Conference Presentations

Jun 2026	Interaction Context Often Increases Sycophancy in LLMs (Short Talk) AI, Metascience, and Methodology, Consortium on Moral Decision-Making \& Center for Social Data Analytics, Pennsylvania State University University Park, PA	AI and Social Research: Empathic
Jun 2026	Active Negotiation: How Users Interact With and Adopt Large Language Models (Poster) Research: Empathic AI, Metascience, and Methodology, Consortium on Moral Decision-Making \& Center for Social Data Analytics, Pennsylvania State University University Park, PA	AI and Social

Mentoring

June 2025 - Present	Patrick Erickson Undergraduate B.S. in Data Science. Research project focused on the adoption and integration of LLMs.	Pennsylvania State University
---------------------	--	-------------------------------

Skills

- **Research Methods:** Qualitative Analysis, AI Auditing, User Studies, Human-Computer Interaction (HCI)
- **Technical:** Machine Learning, Artificial Intelligence, Natural Language Processing
- **Programming:** Python, R, SQL

Memberships

2025 - Present	Association for Computing Machinery (ACM)
2025 - Present	Center for Socially Responsible Artificial Intelligence (CSRAI)